

ZOHAL STANIKZAI

Youth Educator | Life Skills Facilitator | Psychosocial Support Specialist

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Dedicated Youth Educator with over 4 years of progressive experience designing and delivering youth-focused education programs with international NGOs in Afghanistan. Proven expertise in facilitating life skills training, providing psychosocial support (PSS), and engaging vulnerable adolescent populations in community-based and Women Friendly Health Space (WFHS) settings. Passionate about empowering Afghan youth through participatory peer education methodologies, leadership development, and gender-sensitive programming. Demonstrated ability to work effectively with adolescent girls and boys from diverse ethnic and socioeconomic backgrounds, achieving measurable improvements in youth knowledge, skills, and wellbeing. Committed to child protection principles, cultural sensitivity, and delivering quality education under challenging humanitarian contexts.

CORE COMPETENCIES

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| ☐ Youth Education & Life Skills Training | ☐ Psychosocial Support (PSS) & Counselling |
| ☐ Peer Education & Youth-Led Approaches | ☐ Gender-Sensitive & Culturally Responsive Programming |
| ☐ Community Engagement & Mobilization | ☐ Child Protection & Safeguarding |
| ☐ Training Facilitation & Presentation | ☐ Report Writing & Program Documentation |
| ☐ Adolescent Development & Leadership | ☐ MEAL & Results-Based Monitoring |

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Youth Educator / Life Skills Facilitator | HealthNet TPO Afghanistan

Kabul, Afghanistan | March 2022 – Present

- ☐ Design and deliver comprehensive life skills education sessions for 180+ adolescents (ages 12-18) annually across 6 community-based WFHS locations in Kabul, achieving 94% participant retention rate
- ☐ Facilitate peer education training programs, equipping 45 youth peer educators with facilitation skills, reproductive health knowledge, and violence prevention techniques; peer educators reached 800+ additional youth in their communities
- ☐ Provide individual and group-based psychosocial support (PSS) to 120+ vulnerable youth including survivors of violence, child laborers, and out-of-school adolescents, conducting structured needs assessments and referral pathways
- ☐ Develop age-appropriate training curricula and session guides on healthy lifestyles, hygiene practices, GBV prevention, and leadership development; materials adopted across 4 provincial offices
- ☐ Collaborate with community shuras, women's councils, and local stakeholders to ensure culturally appropriate youth engagement and sustained community ownership of programs

Community Youth Officer | International Rescue Committee (IRC)

Nangarhar Province, Afghanistan | January 2020 – February 2022

- ☐ Coordinated youth empowerment activities targeting 250+ out-of-school adolescents in Jalalabad district, combining literacy support with vocational life skills training
- ☐ Led awareness-raising sessions on hygiene promotion, nutrition, and communicable disease prevention for adolescent groups, reaching 500+ youth and their families
- ☐ Established 8 adolescent girls' safe spaces providing structured learning, mentoring, and PSS activities; documented 35% improvement in participants' self-reported confidence and decision-making capacity
- ☐ Trained 20 community volunteers as youth facilitators on child safeguarding, participatory engagement techniques, and gender-sensitive approaches to adolescent programming
- ☐ Maintained accurate program documentation, including attendance records, case notes, activity reports, and MEAL data, ensuring compliance with donor reporting requirements

Education Support Officer | Save the Children International

Herat, Afghanistan | June 2018 – December 2019

- ☐ Supported implementation of accelerated learning programs for 150+ children and youth affected by conflict, assisting in classroom management, learning assessments, and progress tracking
- ☐ Facilitated recreational and psychosocial activities for children in Child Friendly Spaces, contributing to emotional wellbeing and social integration of displaced youth
- ☐ Assisted in conducting baseline and endline assessments, collecting data on education outcomes, youth participation, and program impact indicators for quarterly donor reports

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts in Education & Social Sciences

Kabul University, Kabul, Afghanistan | 2014 – 2018

Specialization in Curriculum Development & Educational Psychology; Graduated with Honors; Thesis: "Participatory Learning Approaches for Afghan Adolescents in NGO Settings"

YOUTH PROGRAM EXPERTISE

- ☐ Life Skills Education (LSBE)
- ☐ Psychosocial Support (PSS)
- ☐ GBV Prevention & Response
- ☐ Community-Based Protection
- ☐ Peer Education & Youth Leadership
- ☐ Healthy Lifestyles & Hygiene Promotion
- ☐ Adolescent Reproductive Health
- ☐ Case Management & Referrals

LANGUAGES

Pashtu	Native
Dari	Fluent
English	Professional Working Proficiency

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Training Facilitation & Participatory Methodologies | Curriculum Development & Session Planning | Monitoring, Evaluation & Learning (MEAL) Tools | Case Management & Referral Systems | Report Writing & Program Documentation | MS Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint) | Data Collection (KoBoToolbox, CommCare) | Stakeholder Coordination & Community Mobilization

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- ☐ Psychosocial Support (PSS) for Youth in Humanitarian Settings — Inter-Agency Standing Committee (IASC), 2023
- ☐ Child Protection & Safeguarding in Development Contexts — Save the Children, 2022
- ☐ Life Skills-Based Education (LSBE) Facilitation Training — UNFPA Afghanistan, 2021
- ☐ First Aid & Emergency Response — Afghan Red Crescent Society, 2020
- ☐ Gender-Based Violence (GBV) Prevention & Response — UN Women, 2020
- ☐ Peer Education & Youth Leadership — International Youth Foundation, 2019

REFERENCES

Available upon request.